

Ch 5: Outcomes of Democracy

Question Bank | 2M | 3M | 5M

SECTION A - 2 MARKS

Q1. Read the statements and choose which correctly describe features of democracy: (I) Promotes equality among citizens (II) Government by few individuals (III) Protection of human rights (IV) Ensures checks and balance system. (PYQ 2024)

Q2. What is the most basic outcome of democracy?

Q3. What is meant by a legitimate government? How does democracy ensure legitimacy?

Q4. What is meant by an accountable government? How does democracy ensure accountability?

Q5. What is meant by a responsive government? Give one example.

Q6. What is transparency in governance? How is it different in democracies and non-democracies?

Q7. What type of government is likely to be most acceptable to people in the world? (PYQ 2023)

Q8. Give one example of economic development in a dictatorial regime. (PYQ 2020)

Q9. What is political equality? How does democracy ensure it?

Q10. What does the Right to Information Act provide to citizens? How does it strengthen democracy?

Q11. "Democracies are based on political equality." What does this mean?

Q12. Why do democracies not always have higher economic growth rates than dictatorships? Give one reason.

Q13. Give one example to show that democracy is better than dictatorship in terms of economic development in the long run.

Q14. What is meant by dignity of the individual? How does democracy protect it?

Q15. What is the principle of one person, one vote? Why is it important?

Q16. How has democracy helped women in achieving dignity and equal treatment? Give two points.

Q17. How has democracy strengthened the claims of Dalits for equal status and opportunity? Give two points.

Q18. Name two practices and institutions that show a democracy is producing a government that is accountable.

Q19. What is the difference between what a democracy can guarantee and what it cannot guarantee?

Q20. Give one reason why some people argue that dictatorship is better for economic growth.

Q21. What does the principle of majority rule mean in a democracy? What is its limitation?

Q22. Name two countries where democracy has failed to reduce inequality and poverty significantly.

Q23. Assertion: Democracy is an accountable, responsive, and legitimate government. Reason: Democracies have regular, free, and fair elections and decision-making is based on norms and procedures. Are both correct? Is R the correct explanation of A? (PYQ)

Q24. What is the difference between an outcome expected from democracy and an outcome actually delivered by it?

Q25. Name two social outcomes that democracy is expected to achieve.

Q26. "Democracy stands much superior to any other form in promoting dignity and freedom of people." Give two supporting points.

Q27. What is meant by 'accommodation of social diversity'? How does democracy achieve it?

Q28. Give one example of how democracy handles social conflict better than non-democracy.

Q29. "People wish to be ruled by representatives elected by them." Why is this considered a merit of democracy?

Q30. What are the three main areas in which the outcomes of democracy are assessed?

Q31. Give two reasons why India's economic growth since independence shows that democracy and development are compatible.

SECTION B - 3 MARKS

Q1. "Democracy is an accountable, responsive, and legitimate government." Explain the statement. (PYQ 2024)

Q2. Analyse the reason for the overwhelming support for the idea of democracy all over the world. (PYQ 2022)

Q3. "Democracies accommodate social diversities and provide dignity and freedom to the citizens." Justify the statement. (PYQ Term-2 2021-22, 2020)

Q4. Explain three ways in which democracy produces an accountable government. (PYQ — frequently asked)

Q5. How is democracy better than dictatorship in terms of political outcomes? Explain three points.

Q6. Explain whether democracy leads to economic growth. What does data show? Give three points.

Q7. Explain three ways in which democracy reduces inequality among citizens.

Q8. Explain three ways in which democracy accommodates social diversity better than other forms of government.

Q9. Explain three reasons why democracy is considered a legitimate form of government.

Q10. Explain how democracy upholds the dignity and freedom of its citizens. Give three examples.

Q11. "Democracy cannot guarantee economic equality but it can guarantee political equality." Explain with three points.

Q12. Explain three shortcomings of democracy in delivering economic outcomes.

Q13. Explain how democracy is responsive to the needs of the people. Give three specific examples.

Q14. Why do people prefer democracy over other forms of government despite its shortcomings? Explain three reasons.

Q15. "Democracy stands superior to any other form of government in promoting dignity and freedom." Justify with three arguments.

Q16. Explain three reasons why reducing inequality remains a challenge even in well-established democracies.

Q17. Explain how the Right to Information and free press contribute to democratic accountability. Give three points.

Q18. Explain the political outcomes of democracy. What three institutions and practices indicate a good political outcome?

Q19. Why is transparency considered one of the most important features of a democratic government? Explain three reasons.

Q20. Explain three ways in which democracy helps in the accommodation of minority groups and their rights.

Q21. "Democracies are slow in decision-making but the outcomes are better." Justify with three points.

Q22. Explain three reasons why the economic outcome of democracy is often debated among scholars.

Q23. How does political equality in a democracy contribute to social equality over time? Explain three links.

Q24. Explain three ways in which democracy has helped women gain dignity and rights in India.

Q25. Explain three ways in which democracy has helped Dalits and other marginalised groups in India.

Q26. Explain the concept of majority rule in democracy. What are its limitations in terms of minority rights?

Q27. Explain why corruption and misuse of power are considered failures of democracy rather than democracy itself.

Q28. Explain the difference between what citizens expect from democracy and what democracy actually delivers in practice.

Q29. Explain three ways in which regular elections contribute to accountable and responsive governance.

Q30. Explain how the principle of one person, one vote has changed the nature of governance in India. Give three examples.

Q31. "Democracy is a government of the people, by the people, for the people." Explain this with three specific examples from India.

Q32. Explain how freedom of the press, free elections, and right to information together make a democracy accountable.

Q33. Explain three reasons why dictatorship may have short-term economic advantages but long-term disadvantages compared to democracy.

Q34. Explain how democracy helps in resolving social conflicts peacefully. Give three examples from different countries.

Q35. Explain three reasons why people in non-democratic countries aspire for democracy.

Q36. Explain the concept of social outcomes of democracy. How does democracy promote dignity and reduce discrimination?

Q37. Explain three ways in which democracy contributes to the moral development of citizens by encouraging participation and responsibility.

Q38. "Democracy may be slow, but it is sure." Justify this statement with three arguments comparing democracy to dictatorship.

Q39. Explain how democracy creates conditions for peaceful transfer of power. Why is this important?

Q40. Explain three limitations of democracy in achieving economic equality and reducing poverty.

Q41. How does the existence of a free press and civil society strengthen democratic outcomes? Explain three points.

Q42. Explain three ways in which democracies have been more successful than non-democracies in handling famines, natural disasters, and public health crises.

SECTION C - 5 MARKS

Q1. "Democracy is an accountable, responsive, and legitimate government." Explain this statement with five points. (PYQ 2024 — High Probability)

Q2. Analyse the reason for the overwhelming support for the idea of democracy all over the world. Give five reasons. (PYQ 2022)

Q3. "Democracies accommodate social diversities and provide dignity and freedom to the citizens." Justify with five points. (PYQ Term-2 2021-22, 2020 — most repeated)

Q4. Evaluate the economic outcomes of democracy. Does democracy lead to better economic growth than dictatorship? Give five points with evidence.

Q5. "Democracy stands superior to any other form of government in promoting dignity and freedom of the people." Justify with five arguments covering women, Dalits, minorities, and political rights.

Q6. Explain the political, economic, and social outcomes of democracy. How does democracy perform in each area? Give five specific points covering all three dimensions.

Q7. "Democracy is better than dictatorship in the long run even if it is slower in the short run." Justify with five arguments covering accountability, rights, legitimacy, social diversity, and stability.

Q8. Explain how democracy creates a government that is accountable to the people. Give five specific institutions, practices, and mechanisms that ensure accountability in a democracy.

Q9. "Democracy cannot guarantee equality of outcomes but it guarantees equality of opportunity." Explain this distinction with five examples from India.

Q10. Critically evaluate the outcomes of democracy. What are its achievements and what are its failures? Give five points each.

Q11. "People all over the world prefer democracy despite its weaknesses." Explain why this is so with five arguments.

Q12. Explain how democracy accommodates social diversity better than any other form of government. Give five examples from different countries including India, Belgium, and Sri Lanka.

Q13. Explain the role of the Right to Information, free press, and independent judiciary in making democracy accountable and transparent. Give five specific examples from India.

Q14. How has democracy in India contributed to the dignity and rights of women and marginalised communities? Give five specific examples of constitutional provisions, laws, and movements.

Q15. Explain how regular, free, and fair elections contribute to the accountability and responsiveness of democratic governments. Give five points with examples from India.

Q16. "Democracy is the worst form of government, except for all others that have been tried." Explain this famous quote with five arguments showing why democracy, despite its flaws, is the best available system.

Q17. Compare the political, economic, and social outcomes of democracy with those of dictatorship. Give five comparative points with examples from countries like China, Zimbabwe, India, and Pakistan.

Q18. Explain the concept of transparency in democratic governance. How does it prevent corruption and abuse of power? Give five specific examples from India.

Q19. "The outcomes of democracy depend not just on the system but on how citizens use it." Explain this statement with five points showing how active citizen participation improves democratic outcomes.

Q20. Explain five ways in which democracy has helped India achieve better outcomes than its non-democratic neighbours in terms of human rights, political stability, and social development.

Q21. "Democracy is not just about elections — it is about everyday governance." Explain this with five examples of how democratic institutions deliver outcomes to citizens beyond election time.

Q22. Explain how democracy in India has both succeeded and failed in reducing poverty and inequality. Give five examples of success and five examples of failure.

Q23. How has the experience of Zimbabwe under Mugabe shown that non-democratic governance leads to economic collapse? Compare it with India's democratic development.

Q24. Explain the concept of legitimate government in democracy. Why do people trust and accept a democratically elected government more than an authoritarian one? Give five reasons.

Q25. "Democracy promotes the idea that mistakes can be corrected and improvements can be made through public debate

and accountability." Justify this statement with five examples of democratic self-correction in India.